



SMART idea 2 – Let's take a vote! (concept checking)

Time required: 10–15 minutes

Materials required:

- Voting cards (supplied below) or ask students to make their own voting cards
- Planned concept check questions

Learning objective:

- To check understanding of a language item or grammatical structure
- To take a 'snapshot' of learners' understanding using the voting cards
- The example given below concept checks the second conditional, but the voting cards can be used to concept check other language points

Write a sentence on the board which includes the target structure you want to check, for example:

If I won the lottery I would buy a sports car

Distribute a set of voting cards to each of the learners: Yes / No / Don't know / Real / Imaginary

Option: Ask learners to make their own cards on different pieces of paper in large letters (that you will be able to see from the front of the class).

Concept check questions (for the example sentence and structure)

1. Have I won the lottery?
2. Am I going to win the lottery?
3. Am I going to get a car?
4. Have I bought a lottery ticket?
5. Is this real or imaginary?



Steps for checking the concept

1. Ask each concept check question one at a time.
2. Ask learners to hold up their voting card after each question.
3. Look around the class to check how learners have voted.
4. Do learners understand the concept you are checking?
5. Ask learners to explain their choices to give you more information about how they understand the concept.

Top tips for writing concept check questions

1. Always prepare your questions before the lesson.
2. Check you understand the target structure.
3. Questions should be easy to understand – aim them just below the learners' language level.
4. Use **yes / no** questions.
5. Ask simple **Wh-** questions.
6. Never include the target structure.
7. Never use unfamiliar vocabulary.

Second conditional language notes

- We use the second conditional when we imagine a situation in the present or future that is unreal, unlikely, or impossible.
- The unreal situation is presented in the 'if' clause (if + past simple).
- The result of the unreal situation is presented in the main clause (would + infinitive).



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Materials – Concept check question voting cards

Yes

No

Don't know

Imaginary

Real

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